

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Making an excuse!



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What are some common excuses people give when they don't want to do something or go somewhere?
- Have you ever used any of these excuses? Which ones?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about emotions, personal qualities and behavior.
- I can talk about future action.
- I can talk about what I will be doing or what I will have done.





Let's Explore!

My team is **counting on*** me to score the winning goal!

* To "count on" means to rely or depend on something or someone.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Hello?
- Sally:** Peter. It's Sally. How are you doing?
- Peter:** Good, but I'm overloaded. I'll be working all week.
- Sally:** I heard. You won't be able to make the axe-throwing event?
- Peter:** No. I work this weekend, Saturday and Sunday. Are you going?
- Sally:** Yes, I will go.
- Sally:** What are you going to be working on?
- Peter:** I'm going to be working on a press release. Why so inquisitive?
- Sally:** We always have a good time with you and I was wondering if there is there anything I could do to help out?
- Peter:** Thank you Sally. That is nice to say, but by Sunday, I will not have finished this thing. I know Vanessa thinks I will have finished everything by Sunday, but I won't and to be honest, I don't want to go axe throwing.
- Sally:** Why not? Vanessa will have worked on this a lot by the time Sunday rolls around.
- Peter:** Because I'd rather do something else. I'm sorry I said yes. It's just not my bag.
- Sally:** Vanessa really would like you to be there. She is counting on you.
- Peter:** You, me and Vanessa will have gone to a million activities by the time this year ends, so what if I miss one. Listen. I got to get back. I'll call you later. Bye.
- Sally:** Hi. Sally. It's Robert. Listen Sally. Sorry I have to break this news to you, but I forgot Andrew and I will be playing softball on Sunday and then we will be attending a party. So we can't make it. Sorry. Hope you find someone.
- Sally:** Oh boy.



Let's Practice!

Let's practice these sentences.

Instructions: Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor. Model a conversation with a partner. Switch roles.

1. We always have a good time with you.
2. Is there anything I could do to help out?
3. That is nice to say. I'm sorry I said yes. It's just not my bag.
4. Vanessa really would like you to be there.
5. She is counting on you.



Let's Practice!

Sally and Peter talk about the weekend.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Rewrite the sentences in the correct order. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor. Model a conversation with a partner. Switch roles.

1. I'll / week / . / be / all / working

2. able / axe-throwing / won't / to / ? / event / the / make / be / You

3. Sunday. / this / Are / work / ? / and / Saturday / I / going / weekend, / you

4. be / working / you / going / What / ? / are / on / to

5. on / going / release / to / I'm / press / . / a / working / be





Extension Activity

Make an excuse!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- In pairs, brainstorm all the different excuses that people use.
- Create six situations that you don't want to do.
- Give another pair of students the situations that you and your partner have created.
- The pairs must think up some good excuses not to do the situation and role play the dialogue.
- Use verbs for future action to describe what you will be doing in the future and give reasons as to why you can't do them.
- Vote for the best one.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I brainstorm different excuses.

☐ ☐

I talk about future ideas to convey excuses.

☐ ☐

I role play the situations.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **overloaded** (adjective): having more work than you can do
e.g. I'm overloaded. I'll be working all week.
- **inquisitive** (adjective): eager to know more about something
e.g. Why are you so inquisitive about what I'm doing?
- **have a good time** (expression): enjoy oneself
e.g. We always have a good time with you.
- **softball** (noun): a game similar to baseball, played on a smaller field with a larger ball
e.g. I forgot Andrew and I will be playing softball on Sunday.
- **not my bag** (expression): used to express that something is not your preference
e.g. Dancing is just not my bag.





Learning Points

The Future Continuous and Future Perfect Tenses

You use the **Future Continuous tense** to talk about something happening at a particular time in the future.

When you use the **Future Continuous**, the action will have started before that moment, but it will not have finished at that moment.

For example:

*I **will be working** at 4 p.m. tomorrow.*

The person will start work at some point in the future and be working at 4 p.m. It is not clear when the person will stop working.

You use the **Future Perfect tense** to talk about an action in the future that happens before another action in the future (often in present tense).

When you use the **Future Perfect**, you can sometimes think of the **Future Perfect tense** like the **Present Perfect tense**, but instead of your viewpoint being in the present, it is in the future.

For example:

*You can call me at work at 8 a.m. I **will have arrived** at the office by 8 a.m.*

*The train will leave the station at 9 a.m. You will arrive at the station at 9:15 a.m. When you arrive, the train **will have left**.*

Look at the chart for the structure of the **Future Continuous** and **Future Perfect** tenses:

Name	Structure	Example
Future Continuous	will (not) + be + v-ing	<i>I'll be working all week.</i>
Future Perfect	will + have + past participle	<i>Vanessa will have worked on this a lot by that time.</i>

Examples:

- *You, me and Vanessa will have gone to a million activities by the time this year ends, so what if I miss one.*
- *Sorry I have to break this news to you, but I forgot Andrew and I will be playing softball on Sunday and then we will be attending a party.*
- *That is nice to say, but by Sunday, I will not have finished this thing.*
- *Vanessa thinks I will have finished everything by Sunday, but I won't and to be honest, I*





Learning Points

don't want to go axe throwing.

The Future

You can use four different tenses to talk about the future.

When you talk about things that are not decided or when you make a decision at the moment of speaking for the future, you use the modal *will*.

When you ask about intentions, you use *be going to*.

When you talk about things that are arranged, on the agenda or booked for the future, you use the Present Continuous tense.

When you talk about schedules, you use the Simple Present.

Will/won't	<i>You won't be able to make the axe-throwing event?</i>
Be going to	<i>I'm going to be working on a press release.</i>
Present Continuous	<i>Are you going axe throwing?</i>
Simple Present	<i>I work this weekend, Saturday and Sunday.</i>

Examples:

- *I work this weekend, Saturday and Sunday.*
- *Yes, I will go.*
- *I'll call you later.*

